Project Costing Report — Campus Ride-Pooling and Split-Fare System

Course: CS455 - Software Engineering, IIT Kanpur
Repository: CS455-Carpooling/Campus_Ridepooling_Automation
Production URL: https://campus-ridepooling-automation.onrender.com/
Costing Basis: Estimated monthly operating cost from published prices, checked on 6 November 2026 (sources in section 8)
Currency: Indian Rupees (INR) & United States Dollars (USD)
Exchange Rate Reference: 1 USD = ₹94.00 INR (rounded planning rate; the reference rate was ₹94.48 on 5 November 2026)

1. Components in Our Website and Is It Costable

Component Name	Description & Functional Scope	Is It Costable?	Cost Classification & Category
Next.js Application	Server-side rendering, client page layouts, UI components, and API routes for student/admin workflows.	**No** (Directly)	Hosted within the web service container; does not incur separate compute charges.
Custom Node.js & Socket.IO Server	Real-time websockets handling live ride coordination, private trip chat, and live in-app notifications.	**Yes**	Billed under Web Service Compute. On the Free tier it runs only while the service is awake.
PostgreSQL Database (`crp`)	Stores persistent records: users, rides, seat requests, trip progress, fare shares, settlements, complaints, and audit logs.	**Yes**	Billed under Managed Database Compute and Storage. Backups come with a paid compute plan.
Google Gemini API Integration	Powers natural language chatbot query parsing, ride matching recommendations, and advisory complaint analysis.	**Yes**	Billed per input and output token on the paid tier. The free tier is not billed.
Google Apps Script Email Relay	Handles verification email dispatch and password resets for `@iitk.ac.in` accounts via MailApp relay.	**No** (Current) / **Yes** (Production)	Free within standard Google account sending quotas; costable if upgraded to dedicated SMTP.
GitHub & GitHub Actions	Stores repository source code, manages deployment webhooks, and runs automated CI linting and test suites.	**No**	Standard GitHub-hosted runners are free for public repositories, and this repository is public.

Component Name	Description & Functional Scope	Is It Costable?	Cost Classification & Category
Docker Build Environment	Packages Next.js, Node.js, and Socket.IO into containerized images for automated deployment.	**No**	Included within the hosting provider's build pipeline quota.
Domain & HTTPS Certificate	Provides public domain access (`*.onrender.com`) and automated SSL/TLS encryption.	**No** (Current) / **Yes** (Production)	Render subdomain is free; custom campus domain (`.in` / `.com`) incurs annual registration fees.

2. Current vs. Production Level Differences

Architectural & Operational Metric	Current Setup (Course Evaluation Demo)	Production Level Setup (Full IITK Campus Deployment)
Target User Base & Capacity	5–10 concurrent evaluator / student test accounts.	1,000–5,000 registered student accounts; 100+ concurrent active Socket.IO connections during peak campus hours.
Web Service Compute Tier	Render Free Tier (512 MB RAM, less than 1 CPU).	Render Starter (512 MB RAM, 0.5 CPU) for the pilot; Render Standard (2 GB RAM, 1 CPU) at full scale.
Web Service Availability & Uptime	Spins down (sleeps) after 15 minutes of inactivity; ~60-second cold start latency; capped at 750 free hours/month.	Does not spin down, so there is no cold-start delay. A single instance still has no uptime guarantee; Render lists uptime SLAs under its Enterprise plan.
Database Instance Tier	Render Managed PostgreSQL Free Tier.	Render Postgres Basic-256mb (256 MB RAM, 0.1 CPU) for the pilot; Basic-1gb (1 GB RAM, 0.5 CPU) at full scale.
Database Storage Limit & Expiry	Fixed 1 GB storage limit; **expires 30 days after creation**, with a 14-day grace period before deletion.	5 GB (pilot) to 20 GB (full scale) of expandable SSD storage; no expiry on a paid plan.
Database Disaster Recovery & Backups	**No automated backups**, no Point-In-Time-Recovery (PITR), no database snapshots.	PITR for the past 3 days on a Hobby workspace or 7 days on a Pro workspace; logical backups kept for 7 days.
Google Gemini API Allocation	Free Tier (`gemini-3.1-flash-lite`); per-project limits are shown in Google AI Studio.	Paid Pay-As-You-Go Tier. Limits rise with the usage tier but still apply.
Transactional Email Delivery	Google Apps Script + MailApp (100 recipients/day on a standard Google account).	Dedicated transactional email service: Resend Free (3,000 emails/month, 100/day) for the pilot; Resend Pro (50,000 emails/month) at full scale.

Architectural & Operational Metric	Current Setup (Course Evaluation Demo)	Production Level Setup (Full IITK Campus Deployment)
Custom Domain & SSL	Default subdomain (`campus-ridepooling-automation.onrender.com`) with shared Render SSL certificate.	Custom Domain (e.g., `ridepool.iitk.ac.in` or custom `.in` domain) with Render-managed TLS.

3. Current vs. Production Price Comparison

> **Gemini API Token Rate Reference (`gemini-3.1-flash-lite`):**
>
> - **Input Token Cost:** $0.25 per 1,000,000 tokens (≈ ₹0.0235 per 1,000 tokens)
> - **Output Token Cost:** $1.50 per 1,000,000 tokens (≈ ₹0.1410 per 1,000 tokens)

Cost Component	Pricing Basis / Rates	Current Setup (Monthly Cost)	Production Pilot (~1,000 Students)	Production Scale (~5,000 Students)
Web Service Compute	Render Starter ($7/mo) / Standard ($25/mo)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹658 ($7.00)	₹2,350 ($25.00)
Managed Database Compute	Render Postgres Basic-256mb ($6/mo) / Basic-1gb ($19/mo)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹564 ($6.00)	₹1,786 ($19.00)
Database Storage & Backups	Paid storage at $0.30/GB/month; backups come with the paid plan	₹0 ($0.00)	₹141 ($1.50)	₹564 ($6.00)
Google Gemini API	Token usage at $0.25/1M input and $1.50/1M output	₹0 ($0.00)	₹799 ($8.50)	₹3,995 ($42.50)
Transactional Email Delivery	Google Apps Script (free) / Resend Free / Resend Pro ($20/mo)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹1,880 ($20.00)
Custom Domain Registration	Amortized monthly cost of annual `.in` domain (~₹900/yr)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹75 ($0.80)	₹75 ($0.80)
GitHub Actions CI/CD	Free: standard runners on a public repository	₹0 ($0.00)	₹0 ($0.00)	₹0 ($0.00)
Subtotal (Excl. Tax)	Net monthly operating expense	**₹0 ($0.00)**	**₹2,237 ($23.80)**	**₹10,650 ($113.30)**
Applicable Taxes (18% GST)	Statutory digital service tax in India	₹0 ($0.00)	₹403 ($4.28)	₹1,917 ($20.39)

Cost Component	Pricing Basis / Rates	Current Setup (Monthly Cost)	Production Pilot (~1,000 Students)	Production Scale (~5,000 Students)
Final Total Monthly Cost	Net out-of-pocket invoice cost	**₹0 ($0.00)**	**₹2,640 ($28.08)**	**₹12,567 ($133.69)**

4. Total Cost Calculation Formula

$$\text{Total Monthly Operating Cost } (C_{\text{total}}) = (C_{\text{web}} + C_{\text{db}} + C_{\text{storage}} + C_{\text{gemini}} + C_{\text{email}} + C_{\text{domain}} + C_{\text{ci}}) \times (1 + T_{\text{GST}})$$

Where:

- C_{web}**:** Monthly fixed instance cost for the hosting web service (Render Compute Plan).
- C_{db}**:** Monthly fixed compute cost for managed database hosting.
- C_{storage}**:** Database disk expansion fee calculated as:

$$C_{\text{storage}} = S_{\text{data (GB)}} \times R_{\text{storage (\$0.30/GB)}}$$

- C_{gemini}**:** Variable AI API consumption cost on the paid tier, calculated as:

$$C_{\text{gemini}} = \left(\frac{N_{\text{input_tokens}}}{1,000,000} \times R_{\text{input (\$0.25)}} \right) + \left(\frac{N_{\text{output_tokens}}}{1,000,000} \times R_{\text{output (\$1.50)}} \right)$$

- C_{email}**:** Monthly fee for dedicated transactional mail delivery over free limits.
- C_{domain}**:** Monthly amortized domain name renewal fee $\left(\frac{\text{Annual Domain Price}}{12}\right)$.
- C_{ci}**:** CI/CD pipeline build execution charges; zero while the repository stays public and uses standard runners.
- T_{GST}**:** Applicable Goods and Services Tax rate (18% or 0.18).

5. Final Total Calculations

5.1 Current Course-Demo Setup

- Web Service Compute: ₹0.00
- PostgreSQL Database: ₹0.00
- Gemini API Usage: ₹0.00
- Email Relay: ₹0.00
- Custom Domain: ₹0.00
- **Subtotal:** ₹0.00
- **GST (18%):** ₹0.00
- **Final Current Total: ₹0.00 / month**

5.2 Production Pilot Setup (~1,000 Students)

- **Web Service (Starter Tier):** $7.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹658.00

- **PostgreSQL (Basic-256mb Tier):** $6.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹564.00
- **Database Storage & Backups (5 GB):** $1.50 × ₹94.00 = ₹141.00
- **Gemini API Usage:**
    - *Assumptions:* 20,000 API calls/month (matching recommendations, chatbot queries, complaint triage).
    - *Input Tokens:* 20,000 calls × 500 tokens = 10,000,000 tokens, so (10,000,000 / 1,000,000) × $0.25 = $2.50 (₹235.00).
    - *Output Tokens:* 20,000 calls × 200 tokens = 4,000,000 tokens, so (4,000,000 / 1,000,000) × $1.50 = $6.00 (₹564.00).
    - *Gemini Subtotal:* $8.50 × ₹94.00 = ₹799.00
- **Email Delivery (Resend Free, under 3,000 emails/month and 100/day):** ₹0.00
- **Custom Domain (.in registration amortized):** ₹900.00 / 12 = ₹75.00
- **Subtotal:** ₹658 + ₹564 + ₹141 + ₹799 + ₹0 + ₹75 = ₹2,237.00 ($23.80)
- **GST @ 18%:** ₹2,237.00 × 0.18 = ₹402.66 ≈ ₹403.00 ($4.28)
- **Final Production Pilot Total: ₹2,640.00 / month** ($28.08 / month)

5.3 Production Full-Scale Setup (~5,000 Students)

- **Web Service (Standard Tier):** $25.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹2,350.00
- **PostgreSQL (Basic-1gb Tier):** $19.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹1,786.00
- **Database Storage & Backups (20 GB):** $6.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹564.00
- **Gemini API Usage:**
    - *Assumptions:* 100,000 API calls/month.
    - *Input Tokens:* 100,000 calls × 500 tokens = 50,000,000 tokens = $12.50 (₹1,175.00).
    - *Output Tokens:* 100,000 calls × 200 tokens = 20,000,000 tokens = $30.00 (₹2,820.00).
    - *Gemini Subtotal:* $42.50 × ₹94.00 = ₹3,995.00
- **Email Delivery Service (Resend Pro):** $20.00 × ₹94.00 = ₹1,880.00
- **Custom Domain:** ₹75.00
- **Subtotal:** ₹2,350 + ₹1,786 + ₹564 + ₹3,995 + ₹1,880 + ₹75 = ₹10,650.00 ($113.30)
- **GST @ 18%:** ₹10,650.00 × 0.18 = ₹1,917.00 ($20.39)
- **Final Production Scale Total: ₹12,567.00 / month** ($133.69 / month)

6. Assumptions and Missing Calculations

- Exchange rate fixed at 1 USD = ₹94.00 INR.
- Statutory Goods and Services Tax (GST) rate calculated at 18% on all cloud hosting and API services.
- Gemini API token rates based on the `gemini-3.1-flash-lite` standard pay-as-you-go pricing model ($0.25/1M input, $1.50/1M output tokens). Output pricing includes thinking tokens.
- Average Gemini request payload modeled at 500 input tokens and 200 output tokens per transaction. This is not measured, and it is likely low: the chatbot's fixed prompt text alone is about 580 tokens, before

the hub list and the rider's message. Doubling both figures would double the Gemini line, from ₹799 to ₹1,598 (pilot) and from ₹3,995 to ₹7,990 (full scale), before tax.

- Current course evaluation setup assumes total web service uptime remains within Render's 750 free monthly instance hours limit.
- A Render Hobby workspace ($0) is assumed. A Pro workspace would add $25/month (₹2,350 before tax) and extend PITR to 7 days.
- Developer salaries, software engineering labor, and UI/UX design costs excluded.
- Local developer workstation depreciation, personal electricity usage, and local internet connection fees excluded.
- Outbound bandwidth beyond Render's Hobby allowance (5 GB/month included, then $0.15/GB) and data migration transfer costs excluded.
- Payment processing and transaction fees excluded (system only records offline cash/UPI settlements).
- Operational monitoring, log aggregation, and error tracking tools (Sentry/Datadog) excluded.
- Third-party SMS verification service fees excluded.

7. Estimated vs. Actual Usage

Usage of the current setup, as of 6 November 2026. "Not read" means the figure exists but was not collected for this report.

Resource	Estimate or Free Limit	Actual	Source
Monthly cost	₹0	₹0: the setup uses the Render Free tier, the Gemini free tier, Apps Script and a public GitHub repository.	Deployment documentation; section 3
GitHub Actions	₹0; standard runners are free for a public repository	465 workflow runs and about 1,030 elapsed minutes, at ₹0.	GitHub API, 6 November 2026
Web service hours	750 free hours per calendar month	Not read. One service cannot pass 744 hours in a month, so it stays within the limit if it is the only free service in the workspace.	Render documentation
Database	1 GB; expires on 5 December 2026	Expiry falls after the 8 to 13 November presentation window. Size not read.	Deployment documentation
Gemini API	Free tier	Not read. Token counts for each call are stored in `ride_recommendation_audits`, `chatbot_audits` and `complaint_ai_analyses`.	`apps/web/db/schema.sql`
Email	100 recipients/day	Not read.	Google Apps Script quotas

Two controls limit the risk of exhausting the free tier. The chatbot allows each rider 20 AI requests per hour, and each AI feature has a non-AI fallback if Gemini stops responding.

8. Price Sources

All checked on 6 November 2026, except the exchange rate, which is dated 5 November 2026.

- Render: pricing, free instances, Postgres backups, legacy Postgres types
- Gemini API: pricing, rate limits
- Resend: pricing
- Google Apps Script: quotas
- GitHub Actions: billing
- Exchange rate: Frankfurter API, which publishes European Central Bank reference rates